



Predsjednik Crne Gore

Montenegro in the EU

Lessons, Issues, and Policy Directions

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE
HILTON PODGORICA, MONTENEGRO 15-16 OCTOBER 2026

AGENDA

DAY 1 · THURSDAY, 15 OCTOBER 2026

16:00–18:00 Welcome & Registration

19:00–20:30 Keynote Dinner · Villa Gorica

Keynote talk by **Jakov Milatovic**, President of Montenegro

Keynote talk by **Ivan Mikloš**, MESA10 and Center for Economic Strategy, former Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Finance and Minister of Economy, Slovak Republic.

DAY 2 · FRIDAY, 16 OCTOBER 2026

08:30–09:10 Registration

09:10–09:30 Opening of the Conference

Center for Finance
Chamber of Commerce
Government of Montenegro
European Union representative

09:30–10:15 Opening Keynote · The Next Europe: Enlargement, Institutions, and Convergence

Senior EU Official/Policy Expert
Enrico Letta, former Prime Minister of Italy
Marek Dabrowsky, The Brussels-based economic think tank Bruegel

10:15–12:00 Panel I · What Actually Worked? What Did Not Work? Why?

Lessons from the New EU Member States

Group 1

Daniel Prinz, Government of Hungary, formerly at the World Bank, **Hungary**
Daniel Daianou, National School of Political and Administrative Studies and Chairman of the Fiscal Council, **Romania**
Lubomir Mitov, World Bank, **Bulgaria**



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10:15–12:00 Panel I · What Actually Worked? What Did Not Work? Why?

Lessons from the New EU Member States

Group 2

Marcin Piatkowsky, World Bank, **Poland**

Maciej Drozd, World Bank, **Poland**

Inna Šteinbuka, Slovak Academy of Arts and Sciences, **Latvia**

Madis Muller, former Governor, Bank of Estonia, **Estonia**

Group 3

Marko Primorac, European Investment Bank and the University of Zagreb, **Croatia**

Mojmir Mrak, University of Ljubljana, **Slovenia**

Rastislav Vrbensky, UNDP Europe, **Slovakia**

Jan Marusinec, MESA10, **Slovakia**

Ivan Mikloš, MESA10 and Center for Economic Strategy, **Slovakia**

12:00–12:20 Coffee Break

12:20–13:30 Rapid Fire · Select Reform Stories I **Three Countries. Three Key Reforms and Outcomes**

Madis Muller — **Digital State**, **Estonia**,

Inna Šteinbuka — **Policy Choices and Reform Outcomes**, **Latvia**,

Rastislav Vrbensky, **Fiscal Reform and auto industrial expansion**, **Slovakia**

Jan Marusinec, **Fiscal Reform and auto industrial expansion**, **Slovakia**

Ivan Mikloš — **Fiscal Reform and auto industrial expansion**

13:30–14:30 Networking Lunch

Macroeconomic management

Regional Connectivity

Finance and Investment Climate

Tourism, Environment & Sustainability

Rule of Law and reform of judiciary

Energy Transition

AI & Digitalization



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14:30–15:45 Panel II · Igniting Productivity Growth and Economic Transformation

Can Montenegro Avoid the Middle-Income Trap and Achieve High-Income Status?

Johannes W. Fedderke, Pennsylvania State University, **on productivity growth**
Alexander Plekhanov, EBRD, **on the evidence on the role of FDI in EU convergence**
Zsoka Koczan, EBRD, **on the evidence on the role of FDI in EU convergence**
Pavle Petrović, Serbian Academy of Arts and Sciences, **on the evidence on productivity growth and EU convergence by Western Balkans states.**

moderator Željko Bogetić, Academic Director of the Conference, and Fellow at the Johns Hopkins University Institute for Applied Economics, Global Health, and the Study of Business Enterprise.

15:45–16:30 Institutions and Development: Lessons for EU and Montenegro's Accession

Presentation by **James Robinson**, University of Chicago, **2024 Nobel Laureate in economics** (by videoconference)

16:30–17:00 Closing Remarks · Issues and Policy Directions



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ORGANIZING COMMITTEE

Dr Željko Bogetić, Academic Director of the Conference, Fellow, The Johns Hopkins University Institute for Applied Economics, Global Health, and the Study of Business Enterprise, Baltimore, U.S.

Dr Nina Drakić, President of the Chamber of Commerce of Montenegro

Prof. dr Ivana Katnić, Member of the Conference Organizing Committee, CEO and founder of Center for Finance

Prof. dr Mojmir Mrak, Academic Co-Director and Member of the Conference Organizing Committee, University of Ljubljana, Slovenia

Prof. dr Igor Lukšić, Academic Co-Director and Member of the Conference Organizing Committee, Center for Finance

mr Slađana Pavlović, Member of the Conference Organizing Committee, Executive Director of Center for Finance Academy

mr Ilija Mugoša, Member of the Conference Organizing Committee, Research Director at Center for Finance

Prof. dr Milorad Katnić, Academic Co-Director and Member of the Conference Organizing Committee, Center for Finance

Esad Zaimović, Member of the Conference Organizing Committee, Center for Finance

mr Nina Perunović, Member of the Conference Organizing Committee, Center for Finance